

YOU WILL NEVER SEE THE WHOLE PICTURE. IT WILL.

A damaged ship. An adaptive threat. An expedition built on incomplete information.

THE PREDICAMENT

You wake as an Engineer aboard a damaged interstellar ship. Power is unstable. The atmosphere is compromised. Restoring a system means reaching it, understanding what has failed and working while something moves through the compartments around you. The ship is your shelter, your means of escape and the place where the danger is taking hold. You cannot simply abandon it. You have to make it work.

THE GAME

Ginnungagap is a first-person industrial science-fiction survival-horror game for Windows, built in Unreal Engine 5.8. Its core experience combines physical ship operation, resource-limited exploration and evasion of the Bloom, a xenobiological antagonist designed to adapt to the crew's behavior. The larger vision is an expedition that carries damage, decisions and uncertainty across multiple jumps. The immediate development goal is one complete solo journey aboard a Corvette.

COMPETENCE UNDER PRESSURE

The player fantasy is being the person who can keep a failing vessel alive. A repair is a reason to enter danger with a purpose. Restoring power can change how a space works; a sealed door can become a way to contain a threat; a quieter route can cost more oxygen. Knowing the ship should make you more capable, while never removing the need to judge what you can afford to do next.

THREE PRESSURES, ONE DECISION

The body has limits. The ship has failures. The Bloom has a memory. These pressures are intended to act on the same choices, so that repairing, navigating and hiding remain connected. Time spent completing a task is time exposed. A tool can solve a mechanical problem while creating an acoustic one. A successful habit can become a liability after a jump. The tension comes from choosing a workable response with the information and resources you actually have.

THE FIRST PROMISE

The Corvette slice targets a 30 to 45 minute solo experience with one Engineer, one Bloom stalker, one complete jump and two distinct aftermaths. A first playable exists; full player and presentation acceptance remain open. This overview describes the intended experience and separates it from later co-op and expedition expansion.

KEEP THE SHIP ALIVE. GET BACK TO CRYO.

The first journey connects practical work to a consequential escape.

01 / WAKE AND PREPARE

Cryo provides the starting point and the protection you must return to. From there, the route takes you to the Suit and Workshop space to recover the Engineering suit, a diagnostic tool and limited supplies. Preparation establishes what you can attempt and what failure will cost. The fixed Engineer role gives the first slice a coherent set of capabilities before the wider crew system is introduced.

02 / RESTORE AND REPAIR

In the Power space, restore emergency power and re-establish thrust. Continue to Damage Control to address one consequential failure through a physical tool activity. Breakers, machinery, doors and repair sites are meant to communicate their state through visible action and feedback. The work takes place in the ship, at equipment the player must reach, so the approach, the repair and the departure all belong to the encounter.

03 / TRAVERSE AND SURVIVE

Maintenance connects a zero-gravity obstacle to a route choice with a genuine alternative. Movement shifts between thrust gravity and coast; the player must read the space as well as the destination. One equipment-gated path is paired with a bypass that trades resources, time or noise differently. The goal is a choice between costs, rather than a mandatory lock disguised as exploration. The Bloom stalker adds pressure to that decision without replacing it.

04 / COMMIT AND RETURN

The route culminates at the CIC, the ship's command center. Restore access, assess imperfect destination information and select a jump. Commitment changes the priority: the job becomes reaching functioning cryogenic protection before departure. The player then wakes to a changed situation. Two aftermath variants are the initial target for showing that survival tactics have consequences beyond the room where they were used.

AN ILLUSTRATIVE CHOICE

You have a damaged system to reach, limited tool charge and a quieter route that will take longer in low pressure. Spending charge may shorten the job but create noise. Taking the bypass may preserve equipment while consuming oxygen and time. The important question is not which route has the better reward; it is which set of risks you are equipped to survive. This example illustrates the intended trade, not a claim that this exact sequence has passed player acceptance.

FAILURE THAT TEACHES THE SHIP

Ordinary death uses checkpoint recovery. The solo acceptance route includes checkpoints at awakening, power restoration and jump commitment, with New Game and Continue behaving distinctly. Players should be able to understand a failure, recover and make a different choice. Completing the route twice, including a death-and-recovery sequence and two different aftermaths, is part of the current acceptance goal.

THE BLOOM LEARNS. YOU READ THE SYMPTOMS.

The threat extends from the thing in the corridor to the information you rely on.

A THREAT YOU WORK AROUND

The solo slice is built around one stalker that patrols, becomes suspicious, pursues, searches and can be distracted or contained. It cannot be permanently killed in this slice. Emergency tools can stagger, redirect or delay it, creating time to move or finish a task. Doors, lighting, sound and route knowledge give the player ways to survive.

ADAPTATION ACROSS THE JUMP

The Bloom is designed to retain consequences from exposure and repeated player behavior, with a jump providing a point at which the threat changes. The initial slice limits this idea to two tactic-sensitive aftermaths so that the relationship can be tested and made readable. The player is not shown a hidden adaptation score. They discover differences through behavior and environmental signs, then decide whether the tactic that worked before is still worth relying on.

UNCERTAINTY WITH EVIDENCE

Hidden does not mean arbitrary. The design goal is to give the player symptoms they can observe and use: a changed response, a compromised system or a pattern that no longer behaves as expected. Sensor information likewise carries confidence and corruption cues. The game asks for judgment under uncertainty, while preserving enough evidence for a decision to feel reasoned. Readability remains a player-testing priority.

EVERY JUMP IS A DEADLINE

Choosing a destination is a commitment made with imperfect foreknowledge. Cryo gives that commitment a physical consequence: the player must get back to protection, rather than selecting escape from a safe abstract screen. Missing cryo is intended to create lasting consequences without normally ending the run outright. The arrival should therefore carry two questions: what did the jump do to you, and what changed aboard the ship while you were under?

WHEN YOUR OWN SENSES ARE PART OF THE PROBLEM

Altered perception and psychosis are part of the broader survival design. They concern what an individual player experiences, while the underlying shared world must remain consistent. In planned co-op, that distinction creates room for crew members to compare observations without every disturbance becoming a universal event. The jump-psychosis concept explores this direction; it does not depict finished effects.

BEYOND THE FIRST STALKER

Reanimated crew, infested drones and contaminated machinery explore how the Bloom could occupy familiar forms and systems. These concepts suggest a threat that compromises the work of an expedition, rather than simply adding more enemies to shoot. Multiple encounter forms and broader systemic variety belong to later production scope. The first task is to make one encounter, its counterplay and its consequences convincing.

Explore the Bloom decision animation in the reviewer package.

SURVIVE ALONE. LEARN TO SURVIVE TOGETHER.

Cooperation grows from shared problems, not tasks that make solo play impossible.

A SECOND PAIR OF HANDS

The accepted solo loop is intended to become the foundation for two-player crew play. A repair occupies one person while another can watch an approach, prepare a door or coordinate the next move. Crew play divides attention and makes information something to compare. The next multiplayer gate is a listen host and one remote player completing the whole route on separate physical machines; co-op is not yet an accepted feature of the current package.

USEFUL SPECIALIZATION

The first co-op step pairs the Engineer with a generalist crew slot. Later Science, Engineering, Medical and Security/Recovery roles are planned to build specialization around the expedition's problems: interpreting information, restoring equipment, managing crew condition and surviving threats. Every mandatory task must retain a solo fallback. Roles create reasons to coordinate.

THREE SHIPS, DIFFERENT DEMANDS

The longer-term fleet consists of Utility Escort, Corvette and Expedition Carrier classes. Their planned differences go beyond exterior scale: layouts, resource profiles, risk patterns and maintenance workloads should change how an expedition is managed. Ship diagrams in the gallery remain exploratory visual references. The current acceptance scope stays within the Corvette's six key spaces and their connections.

AN EXPEDITION THAT CARRIES ITS HISTORY

Early Access is planned around one-to-four-player, multi-jump runs. Variable damage, supplies, mission opportunities, destination confidence and Bloom adaptation provide the ingredients for changing situations. Consequences should persist across encounters. The first slice targets one jump before expansion.

PROGRESS WITHOUT REMOVING VULNERABILITY

Persistent progression is intended to favor side-grade equipment blueprints, role options, ship configurations, cosmetics and recovered knowledge. The aim is to give returning players more ways to prepare and respond, while avoiding permanent raw-stat growth that makes the survival pressures irrelevant. Production inventory, fabrication, medical treatment and broader resource collection enter with the expedition expansion, after the first slice.

A COHERENT WORLD

The visual direction combines vast industrial architecture with a fragile human presence. Manufactured surfaces, legible machinery and damaged structures give the ship practical identity; darkness conceals information and practical lighting reveals selected hazards. Cyan identifies systems, amber signals warning and restrained violet marks the Bloom. Concept imagery explores this direction. Additional ships, carrier interiors and the fractured ring world remain planned or exploratory scope, not promises that every pictured location will ship.

BUILD THE FIRST JOURNEY. EARN THE NEXT EXPEDITION.

A focused delivery sequence for a larger survival game.

WHERE DEVELOPMENT STANDS

Ginnungagap has a first playable in Unreal Engine 5.8. The current priority is the complete solo Corvette route, including meaningful repair and traversal choices, a Bloom stalker encounter, checkpoint recovery, a jump and two aftermaths. Full player acceptance and cohesive presentation remain open. The 30 to 45 minute duration is a target; concept images are not gameplay.

NEAR TERM / THE SOLO SLICE AND PUBLISHER BUILD

First, make the packaged journey repeatable with real input, including a recoverable failure and different aftermaths. Then bring the critical route's art, animation, mechanical feedback, sound and interaction presentation together. Readable prompts, keyboard and mouse, controller usability, accessibility and performance are part of that work. The deliverable is one exact build accepted for publisher demonstration, with known limitations documented and private reviewer access tied to that build.

NEXT / TWO-PLAYER PROOF AND PUBLIC DEMO

Prove the same journey with a listen host and remote client, preserving shared state and private player effects through the complete loop. The public demo is planned to contain the solo and two-player Corvette experience, one stalker, one jump, two aftermath variants and checkpoint recovery. Steam is the intended initial PC storefront. Clean-machine and multiplayer checks precede release approval.

BEYOND / EARLY ACCESS AND 1.0

Expand from the accepted loop into one-to-four-player expeditions and three complete ship classes. Build out mission and destination variety, crew specialization and the supporting survival economy, then harden the experience toward 1.0 with production content, accessibility, localization, save compatibility and sustained co-op testing. Release dates are not yet announced.

THE STUDIO AND THE OPPORTUNITY

Ginnungagap is created by James Shattuck, solo developer at Valewolf Games, the games studio of Skald and Stone LLC. We are seeking development partners for the first complete solo slice and the cooperative expeditions beyond it. Support will help complete the player journey, strengthen its presentation and prepare it for external playtesting.

REVIEW MATERIALS AND CONTACT

The pitch introduces the game; the gallery identifies concept scope and provenance. AI-assisted visualizations establish direction and may change during production. A finished, approved gameplay video will be added later. Playable reviewer distribution remains private and follows exact-build acceptance. For project, partnership and reviewer enquiries, contact james@skaldandstone.com or visit skaldandstone.com/valewolf/ginnungagap/.